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ARTICLES AND QUANTIFIERS

A, An and Some

In affirmative sentences, we use **a** or **an** before singular countable nouns, and **some** before plural countable nouns and uncountable nouns.

Countable Nouns

Countable nouns are things that we can count easily. They have both singular (one) and plural (more than one) forms.

There's **a child**.



There are **some children**.



There's **an orange**.



There are **some oranges**.



Uncountable Nouns

Uncountable nouns are things that we cannot count easily. They do not have a plural form.

There's **some coffee**.



There's **some water**.





DO YOU KNOW?

"Fruit" is generally used as an uncountable noun when referring to the general concept of fruit or when talking about an unspecified quantity. However, "fruits" can be used in the plural form when referring to different kinds or varieties of fruit.

We can use **a**, **some** or a **number** before countable nouns.

Singular

A bottle

One bottle

Plural

Some bottles

Six bottles

Some nouns only have one form. These are uncountable nouns.

👉 milk

👉 juice

👉 homework

👉 butter

We can't count uncountable nouns, so we can't use numbers with them. We use some or nothing before them.

👉 Always do **some** homework after school.

👉 Do you want **butter** on your sandwich?

In positive sentences, we use **there is** and **there are** like this:

There is ... +

Singular Countable Nouns

There is (there's) an apple.

There is (there's) a bus.

There is ... +

Uncountable Nouns

There is (there's) fruit.

There is (there's) traffic.

There are ... +

Plural Countable Nouns

There are (there're)
bananas.

There are (there're)
cars.

Exercises

2.1 Write C for countable and U for uncountable nouns.

hospital

pencil

necklace

salt

money

cup

rain

bread

lesson

river

jewelry

toothpaste

jam

plan

time

petrol

friend

sugar

star

coffee

clock

traffic

2.2 Circle the correct answer.

-  There's **a** / **some** bread in the bag.
-  I can see some **bird** / **birds**.
-  There's **a** / **some** snow on those mountains.
-  There **is** / **are** two men on the boat.
-  Would you like **some** / **an** ice in your drink?
-  I want **some** / **two** free time.
-  You have **a tomato sauce** / **tomato sauce** on your face!
-  I love **rain** / **a rain**.
-  This furniture **is** / **are** very nice.

Quantifiers

how much, how many, some, any and a lot of

We use quantifiers to talk about the quantity of countable and uncountable nouns.

Countable

How **many** ...?

some

(not) any

a lot of

1, 2, 3,

Uncountable

How **many** ...?

some

(not) any

a lot of

We usually use **some** in positive sentences and **any** in questions and negatives.

👉 I've **some** papers and pens.

👉 Do you have **any** money with you?

👉 There isn't **any** butter.

We use **a lot of** with countable and uncountable nouns to talk about a large quantity. We can use it in affirmative and negative sentences and also in questions.

👉 He has **a lot of** friends.

👉 We don't have **a lot of** time.

👉 Is there **a lot of** paper in that box?

With uncountable nouns, we often use expressions with bottles and containers, like **a bottle of** and **a kilo of**.

👉 He has **a spoonful of sugar** in his coffee.

👉 There are **two bottles of milk** in the fridge.

	Countable nouns (measurement or container)	Uncountable noun
I have	two bags of	sugar.
I'd like	a spoonful of	honey.
There are	100 kilos of	rice.
There's	a loaf of	bread.
I've	two litres of	milk.

Here are some common examples:



a litre of water / petrol / apple juice



a kilo of cheese / beef / potatoes



a bottle of water / lemonade



a tin of beans / fruit / soup / paint



a spoonful of sugar / salt / spice



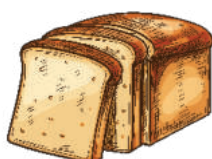
a bag of biscuits / crisps / flour / rice



☞ **a tube of** toothpaste/ glue



☞ **a cup of** coffee / tea / milk



☞ **a slice of** bread / cheese/ cake

2.3 Circle the correct answer.

- ☞ I've **some / any** biscuits.
- ☞ I can see **some / any** stars.
- ☞ Why aren't there **some / any** chairs in here?
- ☞ I'd like **some / any** coffee, please.
- ☞ I need **some / any** money.
- ☞ Are there **some / any** pictures in the book?
- ☞ I can't hear **some / any** birds.
- ☞ We never get **some / any** snow in this country.
- ☞ I need **some / any** help!
- ☞ There aren't **some / any** biscuits left.

2.4

Match the quantities and the nouns.

spoonful

bottle

litre

slice

tube

jar

tin

bag



a

cup

of tea



a

of toothpaste



a

of flour



a

of honey



a

of sugar



a

of bread



a

of water



a

of juice



a

of beans

2.5

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first.

 How many tins of soup are there?

How much soup is there?

 How many litres of juice are there?

How _____ there?

 How many slices of cake are there?

How _____ there?

 How many bags of rice are there?

How _____ there?

 How many bottles of water are there?

How _____ there?

 How many tins of paint are there?

How _____ there?

 How many pieces of fruit are there?

How _____ there?

 How many jars of jam are there?

How _____ there?

 How many loaves of bread are there?

How _____ there?